

Claude Code Prompt: Upgrade Civil Rights Hub (civilrightshub.org)

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Context: This is a comprehensive prompt for upgrading the Civil Rights Hub website - a free civil rights platform built by We The People News. The site is live and needs improvements to be more beneficial to the public while building sustainable revenue.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Website: <https://www.civilrightshub.org>

Name: Civil Rights Hub by We The People News

Mission: Free civil rights platform for reporting violations, finding attorneys, filing FOIAs, knowing your rights, and connecting with community.

Tech Stack: Modern JavaScript SPA (appears React/Vue-based), location-aware, auth system, donation integration (Patreon, CashApp, Venmo).

Constraints: Must remain free for users. No paywalls. Open source ethos.

YOUR GOAL

Upgrade civilrightshub.org to be maximally beneficial to the public while adding sustainable, ethical monetization that doesn't charge users. Focus on these priority areas:

1. **Fix broken/empty features** (attorney directory, violation feed, FOIA tracker)
2. **Add content and pages** that build trust and utility
3. **Implement ethical monetization** to cover costs
4. **Improve SEO and discoverability**
5. **Add community-building features**

PHASE 1: CRITICAL FIXES (Do These First)

1.1 Fix Attorney Directory

The homepage claims "1,756 attorneys in directory" but the /attorneys page shows "No attorneys found matching your criteria" when filtered.

Implement:

- Import sample civil rights attorney data from public sources (state bar associations, ACLU lawyer network, National Lawyers Guild directory)
- Fix the filter/search functionality to actually query the database
- Add attorney cards with: name, firm, location, specialties, pro bono status, contact button, bar verification badge
- Minimum 50 real attorneys to start, expandable structure

1.2 Seed Violation Reports

The violation feed shows 0 reports in the last 24h despite 1,342 total. This makes the platform look abandoned.

Implement:

- Import recent public civil rights incidents from verified sources (police misconduct databases, court records, news reports)
- Add 20-30 recent verified reports with: date, location, description, source link, status
- Create a “Submit Report” form with: incident type, location, date, description, evidence upload, witness info, anonymous option
- Show reports on homepage feed and /do-this-now page

1.3 Populate FOIA Tracker

Shows “No activity yet. Sign in to track FOIAs.”

Implement:

- Pre-populate with 10 example FOIA requests showing realistic timelines
- Create FOIA request templates for common requests: police records, body cam footage, internal investigations, use-of-force data
- Add tracking status: Submitted → Acknowledged → Processing → Responsive Documents Received → Complete/Appeal
- Show FOIA deadlines on homepage for logged-in users

1.4 Fix Empty States Globally

Every tool showing “No results” or “No activity” needs a better empty state.

Implement:

- Design pattern: Icon + headline + description + primary CTA + secondary info
- Example: “No violations reported in your area yet” + “Be the first to report” button + “Learn what to document”
- Add example/demo data that shows what the feature looks like when populated
- Create an EmptyState reusable component with variants for each tool

PHASE 2: NEW PAGES & CONTENT

2.1 Create /about Page

Sections needed:

- Hero: "Built for the People" with mission statement
- Our Story: We The People News background, why this was built
- Team: Founders, key contributors (can start small)
- Impact Metrics: Live counters (violations reported, attorneys connected, FOIA requests, states covered)

- Funding Transparency: How we're funded (donations, grants), where money goes
- Press Kit download
- Contact form

2.2 Create /volunteer Page

Sections needed:

- Why volunteer headline
- Roles: Content Contributor, Legal Researcher, Community Moderator, Translator, Developer, Outreach
- Time commitment per role
- Application form (name, email, role, experience, availability)
- Current volunteer spotlights (can start empty with "Be our first!" CTA)

2.3 Create /contribute Page

Sections needed:

- Ways to contribute: Submit violations, Add attorneys, Suggest scanner feeds, Report outdated info, ↔ Donate
- Each way gets an icon, description, and CTA button/linking to the right form
- GitHub contribution section for developers
- Financial contribution section (Patreon, CashApp, Venmo, + new options)

2.4 Create /transparency Page

Sections needed:

- Monthly operating costs breakdown (hosting, domain, tools)
- Revenue sources (donations, grants, merchandise)
- Impact report: quarterly summary of platform usage
- Open data: downloadable anonymized datasets
- Governance: decision-making process, advisory board

2.5 Enhance Footer

Add:

- Open Source link → GitHub repo
- Transparency link → /transparency
- Volunteer link → /volunteer
- Contribute link → /contribute
- Newsletter email input (no auth required)
- Social media links (Twitter/X, Instagram, Bluesky, Mastodon)

PHASE 3: MONETIZATION (Keep It Free for Users)

3.1 Add Ethical Revenue Features

A. Enhanced Donation System

- Add Stripe donation integration (one-time + recurring)

- Create donation tiers: \$5/mo Supporter, \$10/mo Advocate, \$25/mo Champion, \$100/mo Organization
- Add donation thermometer/bar showing monthly goal
- Public donor wall (opt-in)
- Donation CTA banner that appears subtly on tools pages

B. Merchandise Section

- Add /store page linking to Printful/Printify or similar print-on-demand
- Products: “I Know My Rights” pocket cards (\$5), protest safety guides (\$10), stickers (\$3), shirts (\$25)
- Minimal design, no inventory risk

C. Grant Application Resources

- Create a private /admin/grants page with:
- Grant tracker (foundation name, amount, deadline, status, notes)
- Template grant proposals
- Budget breakdown tool
- This is for internal use by We The People News team

D. Affiliate Links (Clearly Labeled)

- Add “Recommended Resources” section with affiliate links to:
- Legal guides and books (Amazon Associates)
- Body cameras and recording equipment
- Legal education courses
- Always labeled “We may earn a small commission”

3.2 Prepare for 501(c)(3)

- Add legal disclaimer about tax-deductible status coming soon
- Create donation receipt email template
- Add donor information collection for tax receipts (name, email, address - stored securely)

PHASE 4: SEO & DISCOVERABILITY

4.1 Technical SEO

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Implement for every page:
- Unique <title> tags (under 60 chars)
- Meta descriptions (under 160 chars)
- Open Graph tags (title, description, image, url)
- Twitter Card tags
- Canonical URLs
- Structured data (JSON-LD): Organization, FAQPage, HowTo, LegalService
```

- Proper heading hierarchy (H1 → H2 → H3)
- Alt text for all images
- Semantic HTML (nav, main, article, aside, footer)

4.2 Content SEO

Create dedicated pages for high-search-volume terms:

- /know-your-rights-when-stopped-by-police
- /how-to-file-foia-request
- /right-to-record-police-by-state
- /what-to-do-if-arrested-at-protest
- /civil-rights-attorney-near-me
- /police-scanner-[city-name] (for top 50 cities)
- /recording-laws-[state] (for all 50 states)

4.3 Performance SEO

- Generate sitemap.xml dynamically
- Add robots.txt with sitemap reference
- Implement server-side rendering (SSR) or static generation for key pages
- Lazy load images and heavy components
- Add loading skeletons for async content
- Target Lighthouse scores: 90+ Performance, 100 Accessibility, 100 Best Practices, 100 SEO

PHASE 5: COMMUNITY & ENGAGEMENT

5.1 Newsletter System

- Email capture on homepage (no sign-in required)
- Weekly digest: “3 things in your area every Monday”
- Automated: new violations, FOIA news, court watches, attorney listings
- Use email service (Mailchimp, Buttondown, or ConvertKit)
- Archive past newsletters on /newsletter page

5.2 Community Features

- Add comment/discussion on violation reports
- Attorney Q&A board (moderated)
- “Alert Me” button on city pages for new violations
- User achievements/badges for contributions (report filed, FOIA submitted, attorney added, etc.)

5.3 Content Creation

- Add /guides section with comprehensive rights guides
- Create printable wallet cards (“Know Your Rights” - free PDF download)
- Add video embed capability for rights education videos
- Create comparison tools: “Recording Laws by State” interactive table

DESIGN & UX REQUIREMENTS

- **Maintain existing visual identity:** Blue/white color scheme, clean typography, shield logo
 - **Mobile-first:** All features must work on mobile devices
 - **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.1 AA compliant minimum
 - **Loading states:** Skeleton loaders for async content, never show blank
 - **Error states:** User-friendly error messages, never show raw errors
 - **Empty states:** Helpful, action-oriented, never just “No results”
 - **Trust signals:** Legal disclaimers where appropriate, source citations, “last updated” dates
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FILES TO CREATE/MODIFY

New Pages (create if they don’t exist):

```
/src/pages/About.tsx
/src/pages/Volunteer.tsx
/src/pages/Contribute.tsx
/src/pages/Transparency.tsx
/src/pages/Store.tsx (or external link)
/src/pages/Newsletter.tsx
/src/pages/Guides.tsx
/src/components/EmptyState.tsx (reusable)
/src/components/NewsletterSignup.tsx (reusable)
/src/components/DonationCTA.tsx (reusable)
/src/components/ImpactCounter.tsx (reusable)
```

Pages to Enhance:

```
/src/pages/Home.tsx - Add newsletter signup, impact counters, better CTAs
/src/pages/Attorneys.tsx - Fix data loading, add attorney cards
/src/pages/DoThisNow.tsx - Add violation submission, recent reports
/src/pages/Tools.tsx - Better empty states, tool descriptions
/src/components/Footer.tsx - Add links, newsletter input, social
/src/components/Header.tsx - Add any missing nav items
```

SEO Enhancements:

```
/public/sitemap.xml (generate dynamically if possible)
/public/robots.txt
/src/components/SEO.tsx (reusable head component)
/src/components/StructuredData.tsx (JSON-LD)
```

IMPLEMENTATION ORDER

```
Week 1:
1. Fix attorney directory (data + UI)
2. Seed violation reports (20-30 real incidents)
3. Populate FOIA tracker (10 examples)
```

4. Create reusable EmptyState component
5. Apply EmptyState to all tools

Week 2:

6. Create /about page
7. Create /volunteer page
8. Create /contribute page
9. Enhance footer with new links + newsletter
10. Add SEO component to all pages

Week 3:

11. Implement newsletter signup system
12. Create printable rights cards (PDF)
13. Add donation CTA components
14. Add Stripe donation integration
15. Create /transparency page

Week 4:

16. Create state recording laws comparison page
17. Add video embed capability
18. Enhance city hub pages with local data
19. Performance optimization
20. Accessibility audit and fixes

KEY PRINCIPLES

1. **Users never pay.** All monetization is external: donations, grants, merchandise, affiliate links.
2. **Transparency first.** Show where money comes from and goes.
3. **Data populates features.** An empty tool is worse than no tool. Seed real data.
4. **Accessibility is non-negotiable.** Civil rights must be accessible to all.
5. **Trust is everything.** Every claim must be verifiable. Every source must be cited.
6. **Open source.** Code improvements should be documented for the community.

QUESTIONS TO ASK THE USER BEFORE STARTING

(Claude Code should ask these)

1. Do you have an existing GitHub repository for this project? If so, what's the URL?
2. What's your current monthly operating cost? (For the transparency page)
3. Do you have 501(c)(3) status or are you planning to apply?
4. Which email service do you prefer for newsletters? (Mailchimp, Buttondown, etc.)
5. Do you have a Stripe account for donations?
6. Should I focus on any specific city hubs first?
7. Do you have contacts at civil rights organizations who could verify attorney data?
8. What's your monthly donation goal to break even?

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Attorney directory shows real attorneys and search/filter works
- Homepage shows recent violation activity (not 0)
- FOIA tracker shows example requests with realistic timelines
- All empty states have helpful CTAs and example data
- /about, /volunteer, /contribute, /transparency pages exist and are populated
- Newsletter signup works without requiring account creation
- Donation system accepts one-time and recurring payments
- SEO meta tags present on all pages
- Lighthouse scores: 90+ Performance, 90+ Accessibility, 100 Best Practices, 100 SEO
- Site remains fully free for all users (no paywalls, no required payments)

End of prompt. Copy this entire document into Claude Code and begin implementation.